

Report on Training School – “Computer Vision in Archaeology”

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It was a great pleasure to participate in a 5-day workshop on Computer Vision in Archaeology, hosted by the Institute of Archaeology of the Czech Academy of Sciences in Brno and co-organised by the MAIA COST Action.

The training school offered an extensive programme covering a wide range of topics, from the basics of Python and coding with AI agents to more specialised applications of computer vision in archaeology and heritage. We worked with images of archaeological artefacts, microscopic images, satellite imagery, and rock art data, which provided a great overview of just how versatile computer vision can be across different types of archaeological research. We also had the opportunity to present our own research projects and ideas for applying computer vision. This was particularly valuable, as it allowed us to discuss our approaches with other participants and get new perspectives on how these methods could be applied to different archaeological questions.

My participation was especially important to my ongoing PhD project, in which I use computer vision to explore the behavioural aspects of early stone tool technologies. In particular, the sessions on annotation tools and data preprocessing will be extremely useful for my future work and for developing my current computer vision workflow for analysing knapping behaviours.

Beyond the technical skills, the training school was also a fantastic opportunity to meet researchers with different backgrounds and levels of experience from across Europe, exchange ideas, and discuss our approaches to archaeological research. The social programme was equally enjoyable, and I am sure that everyone appreciated the amount of thought, care, and hospitality that went into organising the whole event.

Overall, this was an extremely valuable and inspiring experience, and I am very grateful to all the organisers, lecturers, and participants for making it such a great week!